Excel for Accounting and Inventory Reporting

(Automate calculations and reduce errors in daily reporting)

Overview

This course uses an artifact sequence approach in which participants build a complete, formula-driven accounting and inventory workbook across five topic blocks. At the start of the session, participants import a live dataset from the web and rename it as a named Table. Each topic block then builds on that Table: extending it with calculated columns, automating calculations, cross-referencing records, summarizing results with formula-driven summaries and a chart, and validating the completed workbook before distribution.

Objectives

Upon completion of the course, participants will be able to build a formula-driven, error-resistant Excel workbook for accounting and inventory reporting.

Specifically, participants will be able to:

- organize raw data into structured Excel Tables for accurate, scalable formulas
- automate recurring calculations using conditional and lookup functions
- cross-reference records across tables to reduce manual checking
- summarize and present data using formula-driven summaries, conditional formatting, and charts
- validate and protect a completed workbook before distribution

Who Should Participate

- Assistant to Managerial-level staff who prepare or review accounting and inventory reports.
- Employees who use Excel daily for reporting and want to work more efficiently.
- Staff who rely on manual re-typing, copy-paste, or unstructured ranges for reporting.
- Anyone with basic Excel familiarity who needs reliable, formula-driven reporting skills.

Key Topics

I. Working with the Imported Excel Table
   a. Applying Table styles and print-ready layout
   b. Adding calculated columns to the Table
   c. Freezing panes and adjusting column widths
   d. Adding a Total Row to summarize key columns

II. Automating Everyday Calculations
   a. Typing SUM, AVERAGE, COUNT, and COUNTA formulas
   b. Using IF to flag stock and payment status
   c. Using SUMIFS and COUNTIFS for conditional sums
   d. Wrapping formulas in IFERROR for clean outputs

III. Cross-Referencing Data Across Tables
   a. Matching records across tables using XLOOKUP
   b. Convert query-connected tables to ranges
   c. Dropdown lists via Data → Data Validation
   d. Sorting and filtering via Sort and AutoFilter

IV. Summarizing and Presenting Data
   a. Building a SUMIFS-driven summary sheet
   b. Applying conditional formatting for exceptions
   c. Inserting a chart via Insert → Charts
   d. Structuring a management-ready report layout

V. Validating and Finalizing the Workbook
   a. Testing formulas against a revised dataset
   b. Auditing via Formulas → Formula Auditing tools
   c. Resolving #N/A, #REF!, and #DIV/0! error states
   d. Protecting the sheet via Review → Protect Sheet